



Eol Template Outline (+/- 1,500-2,500 words per Eol) – Due date CoB September 19

Please submit Eols to Masud Rana (MASUD.RANA@cgiar.org)

Section 0 – Title and contact Information

- Title of the proposed solution track: **Scaling Climate-Smart Agro-Advisories through the Shamba Shape Up Content Generation Platform**
- Title of the AoW2 Flagship that the solution track aligns with: Flagship 1.1: Scaling Digital Climate Services for Farmers and Enterprises (Grand Challenge 1: Close the Climate Adaptation Gap through Scalable Climate Services and Smart Water Management)
- Lead Scientist(s) / Contact Person(s) / Center(s): Pedro Chilambe
- Emails of the Lead Scientist(s) / Contact Person(s) / Center(s): p.chilambe@cgiar.org
- Key CGIAR Center Partners (in the case of multi-Center Eols)
- Technical link to other Science Programs: Climate Action Science Program (CASP), the Sustainable Farming Program, and the Sustainable Animal and Aquatic Food Systems Program.

Section 1 – Innovation Package, Value Proposition & Alignment

The problem to be solved: The pain points of smallholder farmers

Millions of smallholder farmers across East and Southern Africa face increasing challenges from climate variability, unreliable extension services, and fragmented access to agro-advisory. Traditional extension models cannot meet the scale, speed, or cost-effectiveness needed to reach households at risk from climate shocks. In Kenya, Zambia, and Ethiopia, farmers continue to lack localized, actionable seasonal forecasts, integrated soil and water advisories, and affordable channels for learning. Women and youth, often with limited literacy and resources, are disproportionately excluded from conventional extension channels. The challenge we seek to address through this solution track is how to deliver climate-sensitive, trusted, and inclusive advisories that enable farmers to adapt their practices, reduce risks, and improve productivity. Shamba Shape Up (SSU), Africa's most trusted 'farm makeover' TV and radio program, already reaches over 9–10 million farmers in Kenya and 1.6 million in Zambia (rebranded as Munda Makeover). Building on this trust, the SSU model offers a unique platform to broker CGIAR science into farmer-facing edutainment¹, ensuring that proven innovations are translated into widespread adoption.

¹ Education through entertainment



Our scaling ambition: Reaching those in need, with what they need.

Our scaling ambition is to reach 20 million households across East and Southern Africa with climate-smart agro-advisories by 2030. By 2026, the platform will reach 10 million farmers across Kenya, Zambia, and Ethiopia, expanding to 16 million by 2028. This will be achieved by leveraging the trusted SSU platform to translate CGIAR science into practical, accessible formats. The ambition is not incremental but transformational: to move CGIAR research beyond pilots to millions of households by leveraging mass media and mobile platforms. This represents a clear pathway, creating an uncontested space for scaling agricultural science through trusted, farmer-facing edutainment platforms.

Innovation & Value propositions: How we will generate gains and relieve the pains of farmers.

The SSU Content Generation Platform is an innovation package that combines several elements: a content generation hub that translates CGIAR science into farmer-friendly narratives; a multi-channel delivery system spanning TV, radio, SMS, IVR, WhatsApp, YouTube, and the iShamba call center; an online content library archiving extended episodes; and continuous farmer feedback loops that feed into CGIAR science and private sector pipelines. Furthermore, a challenge fund is planned to crowd-in climate-sensitive content from CGIAR programs and private sector innovators, that will enable showcasing their content on the show. For example, by investing in two segments, this will be matched with funding to allow a total of four segments to be aired. This co-investment model not only multiplies reach but also creates strong incentives for collaboration between S4I and other CGIAR Science Programs, as it offers a practical platform for their innovations to be featured, adapted, and scaled through mass-media delivery. In doing so, S4I positions itself as a catalyst, enabling other programs' research outputs to move from pilot stage into large-scale farmer uptake pathways, thereby amplifying the collective impact of CGIAR science.

The value proposition is multifaceted: farmers gain trusted, practical, localized, climate-smart advisories; governments gain a cost-effective extension mechanism, leveraging digital channels to disseminate its expertise, leveraging this multi-channel to reach even the most vulnerable and remote population; CGIAR gains a broker platform to translate science into scale, generating linkages between the science programs and this platform to scale the reach and adoption of CGIAR technologies; the private sector gains branding and testing opportunities; and donors gain measurable, large-scale impact.



Customers & Alignment

Institutional customers for this track include Ministries of Agriculture in Kenya, Zambia, and Ethiopia, bilateral donor programs such as the GEF and AICCRA, and agribusiness and ICT providers. The main end-users are smallholder farmers, cooperatives, and SMEs across the region. The track aligns directly with Flagship 1.1 of S4I and supports CGIAR's impact targets on adaptation, resilience, poverty reduction, and gender inclusion.

Evidence of Impact

There is robust evidence of impact and scalability. In Kenya, [nine in ten farmers identify SSU as their most trusted source of farming information. Eighty eight percent have made changes](#) because of their learnings on the show, showing the effectiveness of this medium to disseminate technologies and knowledge. Topics adopted include improved harvesting and storage, potato and sweet potato practices, and the use of modern cooking technologies. In Zambia, the Munda Makeover spin-off has already reached [2.3 million people](#) in just two years since its launch, demonstrating the feasibility of cross-country replication. In addition, pilots delivering La Niña forecast content in Zambia and Kenya demonstrated farmers' ability to reduce crop losses by adjusting planting decisions. Evidence frameworks including the IPSR Innovation Profile, MELIA surveys, and KAP studies confirm both the effectiveness and scalability of this innovation package.

Section 2 – Scaling Pathway, Sustainability, Partnerships & Risks

Scaling pathways & sustainability:

As described above, the SSU Generation Platform allows for effective and inclusive scaling of agro-climate advisories. By breaking down technical information into readily understandable content, and showcasing this visually with farmers themselves, those viewing easily trust and act upon this information. This enables spillover effects even to those who may then witness new practices indirectly on their neighbor's or family's plots, and thus long-term sustainability.

The use of the SSU Content Generation Platform itself will scale through a public-private partnership model anchored in mass media and digital services. Mediae Co. provides the production backbone, CGIAR centers supply science-driven content, governments integrate SSU content into national extension systems, and private sector partners co-invest through sponsorship and distribution support. The challenge fund will be a critical mechanism to



ensure sustainability by attracting content contributions and co-financing from CGIAR programs, private sector innovators, and government partners, creating a continuous pipeline of relevant, climate-sensitive content. Financial sustainability will be achieved through blended financing, co-financing from governments through available resources (Studio's, Government airtime on national television, Experts), private sector sponsorships, and donor investments from sources such as GEF and AICCRA. By 2026, the content generation platform and challenge fund will be fully operational, reaching 10 million farmers. By 2028, the platform will expand into Ethiopia and consolidate in Kenya and Zambia, reaching 16 million farmers. By 2030, the reach will expand to 20 million households across East and Southern Africa, with at least 30 percent of the operating costs covered through co-financing from governments and private partners.

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Partnerships & Leverage: Continued collaboration beyond centers and programs

The platform benefits from a strong ecosystem of partnerships. Within CGIAR, the Alliance of Bioversity and CIAT, CIMMYT, IFPRI and IWMI are internal champions. Externally, Mediae Co. anchors the production, while media houses such as Citizen TV in Kenya, ZNBC in Zambia, and broadcasters in Ethiopia serve as key dissemination partners. The private sector, including input providers, insurers, ICT companies, and telecom operators, see SSU as an opportunity to reach farmers with products and services. Development partners including FAO, UNDP, and bilateral donors such as FCDO, SDC, and BMZ, as well as the Soil and Water Accelerator in Zambia, provide additional opportunities for leverage. Evidence of demand is clear: farmer trust and adoption rates, the success of the Zambia spin-off, and explicit government interest in embedding SSU into national extension strategies.

Risks & Bottlenecks

There are risks and bottlenecks that must be addressed. Financial risks include dependence on donor funding, mitigated by diversification through PPP financing. Political risks such as shifts in government priorities or media regulations will be mitigated through early MOUs with ministries and media regulators. Operational risks from cross-country scaling will be mitigated by establishing decentralized production hubs and building local partnerships. Social inclusion risks, particularly the risk of women and youth being underserved, will be mitigated by dedicated gender-responsive content and the use of Gender-Up principles. Institutional bottlenecks, including potential resistance from extension systems, will be addressed by demonstrating cost-effectiveness and complementarity. Technology bottlenecks such as low digital penetration will be mitigated by combining high-reach radio and TV with SMS and IVR. Finally, bottlenecks in climate information will be addressed



through stronger partnerships with national meteorological agencies and the CGIAR Climate Action Program.

Section 3 – Responsible Scaling Trajectory & Achievable Scaling Target

Readiness & Responsible Scaling:

The SSU innovation has been validated as a proven innovation in the [IPSR](#) framework, demonstrating high readiness for scaling. It is trusted by 90 percent of viewers, Over 80 percent report learning, and around 50 percent report adopting new practices. Responsible scaling will be built on Gender-Up guidance provided through capacity building to Mediae through the Ukama Ustawi Initiative and Scaling Readiness principles. The program will ensure women and youth inclusion in content design and delivery, use local languages and low-literacy formats such as radio and IVR, embed environmental sustainability messages on i.e. soil fertility, water management, and agroforestry, and maintain farmer feedback loops through KAP surveys, iShamba analytics, and interactive polls.

Achievable target, Resources & Activities:

With S4I support, the SSU Content Generation Platform will reach 10 million farmers across Kenya and Zambia, by 2026 and 16 million by 2028 with the inclusion of Ethiopia. At least 40 percent of these farmers are expected to adopt one or more climate-smart practices.

The resources required include core staff for content generation, MELIA and coordination, contributions from CGIAR science programs, production capacity from Mediae Co., and co-financing from governments and donors. Key activities will include the establishment of the content generation hub and online library, the launch of the challenge fund, production and broadcasting of TV, radio, and digital segments, expansion of farmer engagement through SMS, WhatsApp, and iShamba, MELIA studies, roadshows in Zambia and Ethiopia, and policy engagement with Ministries to embed SSU into extension systems.

Table 1 Annual Budget

Budget line	Amount (USD)
Challenge Fund CG Science programs:	100,000.00
Challenge Fund CG Private Sector:	100,000.00
Content generation platform:	50,000.00
Learning platform (Online Library):	10,000.00
Staff costs:	240,000.00
Total	500,000.00



Timeline, Milestones & Monitoring:

By 2026, the platform will be fully operational, the challenge fund launched, and 10 million farmers reached, supported by formal MOUs with Ministries of Agriculture in Kenya, Zambia, and Ethiopia. By 2027, an online library will be established, the reach will expand to 12 million farmers, and evidence of adoption will be documented, with at least 30 percent women and 20 percent youth reached. By 2028, regional reach will expand to 16 million farmers, with integration into national extension budgets and adoption rates of at least 40 percent documented. Progress will be monitored through annual KAP surveys², continuous iShamba³ analytics, MELIA reporting on adoption and inclusion, quarterly partner learning sessions, and annual impact assessments. This monitoring framework ensures adaptive learning, transparency, and responsible scaling throughout the trajectory.

Optional Annexes

- IPSR Innovation Profile (if available)
 - [Shamba Shape Up: Using digital channels to deliver bundled agriculture, climate, and financial information services: IPSR Innovation Profile](#)
- [Scaling Readiness assessment results](#)
- Prior project reports
 - Munda Make Over Episodes Series 1: <https://hdl.handle.net/10568/129267>
 - Munda Make Over Episodes Series 2: <https://hdl.handle.net/10568/137482>
- Media or other evidence of prior scaling work that can be accelerated
 - [Munda Makeover - Using digital channels to deliver bundled agriculture, climate, and financial information services in Zambia: IPSR Innovation Package and Scaling Readiness Report](#)
- MELIA studies, impact assessments, reports, publications
 - [Impact of shamba shape up and iShamba on livestock and climate resilience](#)
 - [Munda Make Over Series 2 Changes In Knowledge, Attitudes And Practices. 2024](#)
 - [Shamba Shape Up Series 13 Impact of viewing farmers Knowledge, Attitude and Practices 2023](#)
 - [Shamba Shape Up Series 14 Impact of viewing farmers Knowledge, Attitude and Practices 2024](#)
- Partner commitments (MOUs, LOIs, letters of support)

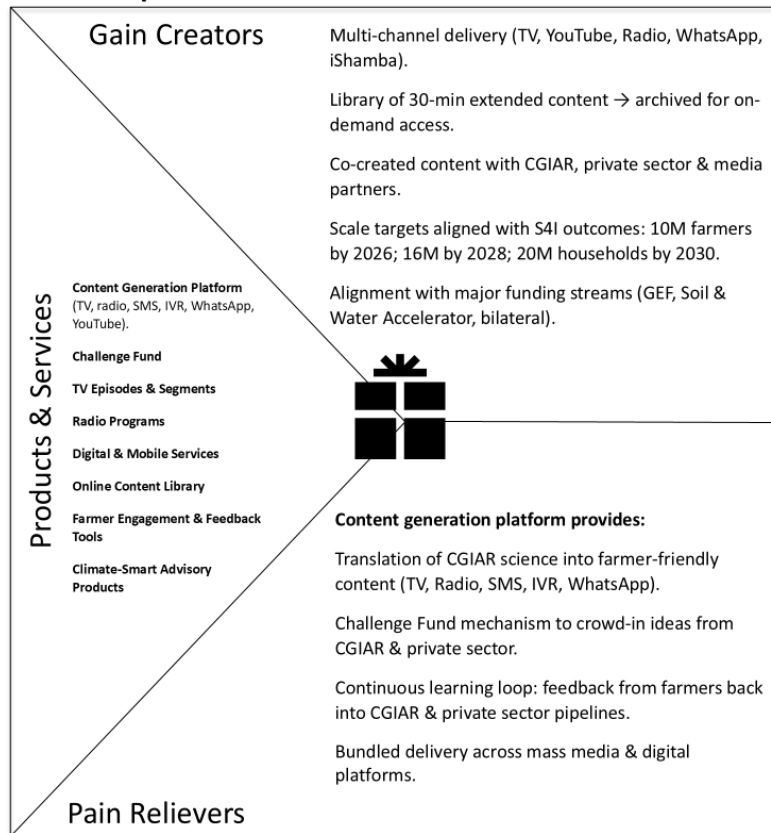
² S4I will work with the Mediae company to improve its Knowledge, Attitudes and Practices survey and support it in tracking impact towards its own and S4I outcomes.

³ S4I will leverage Mediae's call center service to collect data from viewers to support MEAL services for this track.

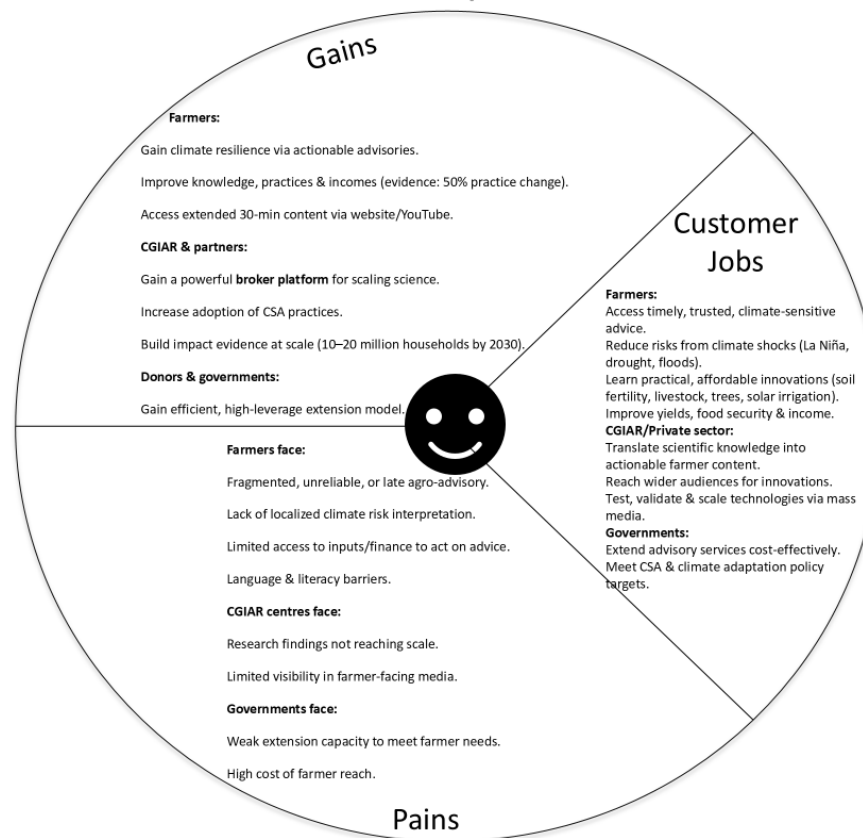


Annex 1 Value Proposition and Business model canvas

Value Proposition



Customer profile



Value Proposition Canvas

Business Model

Key Partnerships:

CGIAR Science Programs: Climate Action, SAAF, SAF.
Media partners: Citizen TV, ZNBC, local radio & digital channels. **Private sector:** Input suppliers, insurance, ICT firms.
Governments: Ministries of Agriculture (Kenya, Zambia, Ethiopia). **Donors:** GEF, bilateral agencies, accelerators (e.g., AICCRA, Soil & Water Accelerator). NGOs/INGOs: FAO, UNDP, local farmer organizations.

Key Activities:

Translate CGIAR science into farmer-facing media content. Operate challenge fund to crowd-in ideas & content. Produce & broadcast TV, radio, digital segments. Manage extended online content library. Run continuous learning loop (farmer feedback → CGIAR & private sector). Engage governments, private sector & donors for co-financing. Monitoring & impact evaluation of farmer reach & behavior change.

Key Resources:

Media production expertise (Mediae Co. & partners). CGIAR scientific content (Climate Action, SAAFs, SAF). Content generation platform (digital repository & distribution system). iShamba platform & call center. Farmer trust & established brand recognition (SSU trusted by >80% of viewers). Partnerships with national broadcasters (Citizen TV, ZNBC, etc.).

Value Propositions:

For farmers: Trusted, climate-sensitive, multi-platform agro-advisories that improve yields, income, and resilience (proven by 50% adoption of new practices). **For CGIAR:** A scaling broker to mainstream science into farmer-facing media, increasing visibility and impact. **For governments:** Cost-effective extension amplification reaching millions of households. **For private sector:** A platform to showcase innovations, bundled with farmer-trusted edutainment. **For donors:** Scalable, evidence-based channel to reach up to 20M households by 2030, aligned to SDGs & NDCs.

Customer Relationships:

Farmers: Interactive two-way engagement via iShamba, SMS, WhatsApp Q&A, call centers.
CGIAR & private sector: Challenge fund mechanism for co-creating and submitting content ideas. **Governments:** Partnership-based integration into CSAIPs and national extension priorities. **Donors:** Evidence-based MELIA (Monitoring, Evaluation, Learning & Impact Assessment) demonstrating cost-effectiveness.

Channels:

TV (30-min extended episodes, 5-min broadcast segments). Radio (national & community FM). SMS / IVR / WhatsApp. iShamba mobile app & call center. YouTube & website with content library. Social media engagement.

Customer Segments:

Primary beneficiaries: Smallholder farmers & households in East & Southern Africa (Kenya, Zambia, Ethiopia expansion ESA-wide). Women & youth farmers (at least 40% target share). **Secondary beneficiaries / users:** National & county governments (extension systems). CGIAR Science Programs (Climate Action, Sustainable Farming, SAAF). Private sector (agribusinesses, ICTs, input suppliers, insurance providers). Donors & development partners (GEF, bilaterals, accelerators). Media & telecom companies (Citizen TV, ZNBC, radio, digital platforms).

Cost Structure:

Content generation & production (TV, radio, digital editing). Challenge fund design & management. iShamba platform operations (call center, SMS, WhatsApp). MELIA (surveys, feedback loops). Roadshows & projector screenings (Zambia, Malawi). Staff & coordination (Mediae + CGIAR scaling team). Partnership & outreach costs (government engagement, donor reporting).

Revenue Streams:

Donor & bilateral funding: GEF, Soil & Water Accelerator, bilateral climate funds. **CGIAR S4I investment:** Flagship support for scaling digital climate services. **Private sector contributions:** Sponsorship of episodes, roadshows, bundled advisory services. **Government co-financing:** Co-funding of studio space and content, **Longer-term revenue:** Possible subscription/premium services via iShamba & digital channels.



Annex 1: Resources & Tools to Support EOI Preparation

Teams pre-paring EOIs are encouraged to draw on the following core resources. These tools are directly aligned with the S4I operational criteria and will help ensure EOIs are evidence-based and robust:

Core Resources

1. **Scaling Scan**
 - Practical tool to assess strengths and weaknesses across 10 “scaling ingredients.”
 - Helps identify gaps in demand, finance, governance, partnerships, or capacities.
 - Resource: [Scaling Scan](#)
2. **Innovation Packages and Scaling Readiness (IPSR)**
 - CGIAR’s framework for assessing innovation maturity (readiness) and use, and for identifying bottlenecks and strategies for scaling.
 - Can provide a Scaling Readiness Level (SRL) and bottleneck map useful for Criterion 3.
 - Resource: [CGIAR IPSR Overview](#)
3. **Business Model Canvas (BMC-lite)**
 - Adapted version of the BMC for development contexts.
 - Useful for thinking through value proposition, partnerships, cost structures, and sustainability.
 - Resource: [Business Model Canvas](#): Templates and examples available via AoW2 co-leads.
4. **Responsible Scaling Guidance**
 - [GenderUp](#): A tool to integrate gender and inclusion into scaling design, helping identify trade-offs and opportunities for equitable, responsible scaling
 - Helps applicants strengthen Criterion 3 (Responsible Scaling safeguards).
5. **MELIA (Monitoring, Evaluation, Learning, Impact Assessment) Evidence**
 - [Past MELIA studies](#), adoption surveys, or bilateral project evaluations are valuable sources of impact evidence.
 - Resource: Contact MELIA focal points within your Center for relevant reports and datasets.